

Did I Just Become Dangerous Overnight?

It's 20 minutes to 2am on a Monday morning, and I still haven't slept. Not because I couldn't. Because I didn't want to stop.

It started as a birthday gift.

Someone very dear to me was visiting to celebrate her birthday, and I was looking for something memorable. Something lively, something that actually meant something.

As a founder, you don't exactly have a lot of "creams" lying around for grand gestures. But I know her business well. I know her, I know her style. And I thought, why not build something real instead of buying something forgettable?

So I opened my laptop and started building her a website. I called it 1.0.

By the time I pushed v1.3.0 to GitHub around midnight on Saturday, with the reactive layer working, the mobile bug fixed, the SEO clean, and both her site and my own personal site shipped in one weekend, I had one genuinely uncomfortable thought:

(If you want to see what came out of that weekend: njugunahilary.com is mine, and houseofgemini.co.ke is hers.)

Did I just become dangerous overnight?

I don't think that question is really about the tools I used to get there. I think it's about something underneath it.

What this is actually about

If you've read my previous entries, you'll know the themes that keep showing up: freedom, belief, failure, building Afrifama from nothing in a place most people overlook.

This one belongs to that same thread, not a different one.

Because the honest answer to "did I become dangerous overnight" isn't about Codex or Claude or which model I burned through fastest at 2am. It's about identity. It's about the gap between the person I thought I was allowed to become, and the person I actually am when I stop asking permission.

For the longest time, even back in school, I believed school wasn't meant to define us. It was meant to open our brains.

That belief cost me nothing to hold and everything to actually live by. Because living by it means building the thing before you feel ready. Shipping the version before you feel qualified. Calling yourself dangerous before anyone else has agreed to call you that.

This weekend, I didn't become someone new. I just stopped waiting for someone else to hand me the identity I'd already earned.

The upset that mirrored the weekend

That same weekend, over at Silverstone, Kimi Antonelli had pole position. He led. For long stretches of the British Grand Prix, the win was his to lose.

Then his car started fading. A broken front-left wheel shield, picked up after clipping a kerb. What should have been a win turned into a fight just to salvage points, and even that slipped away under a penalty. This was the second time this season it happened to him.

Barcelona did the same thing a few weeks back, when he was running P2 and lost it in the final laps to another car problem. Two results like that, right in the middle of a run where he'd won five in a row and everything felt like it was finally clicking.

He didn't retire the car either time. He nursed it home.

There's one detail from that Silverstone race that stuck with me more than the result. With the car damaged and barely turning, his team told him to box and retire.

He refused.

He stayed out, pleading with them over the radio to let him keep fighting for even a single point. That's not recklessness. That's a driver who has decided, mid-crisis, that a diminished version of the result is still worth chasing harder than anyone watching thought was reasonable.

Mercedes' own team boss admitted afterward that the failure was on them, not on him. The car simply shouldn't have broken. Antonelli's response to being told to stop wasn't to accept the excuse. It was to keep pushing anyway.

That's the founder instinct I recognise.

Nobody tells you to keep going when the thing has already failed. Everyone around you, reasonably, tells you to box. The decision to stay out anyway, not out of denial, but because

you've done the math and you still think there's a point left to fight for. That's the same decision I make every time something in Afrifama breaks and the sensible move is to pause.

You don't always get the point. But you don't get it at all if you box the moment things start going wrong.

That's the part that connects to identity more than to technology. Antonelli's belief in himself as a race winner didn't disappear the moment the car failed him, twice.

Belief that survives failure without needing the result to validate it is the only belief that was ever real to begin with. Mine either survives this pace, this uncertainty, this country's constraints, or it was never belief. It was just confidence borrowing off convenient circumstances.

Where this leaves me

I have an early morning ahead of me, and I know it. This isn't sustainable as a weekly pace, and I know that too.

But every hour behind that desk this weekend went toward something I actually believe in, for people I care about, in a country and an industry that's been overlooked for far too long.

So if you're reading this: the question was never whether you're capable of the thing you're avoiding. It was whether you'd decided who you are before you'd built any proof of it.

Decide first. Build second. The proof comes either way.

Be dangerous. Not because of what you used, but because of who you decided to be before you had permission.

This is Diary of an Entrepreneur.

It's 28 minutes past 2am now. I started this entry not knowing where it would end, and somehow it ended here.